

Workstream 03 — Directory Submissions

paradigmconsulting.io

What this workstream does

Directory submissions are the lowest per-asset authority impact of the three workstreams — but they stack. A single directory listing might be worth a fraction of a podcast appearance, but 30-50 of them produce a compounding baseline of referring domains that elevate the entire site's domain rating, surface the brand in buyer-side search ("compliance consulting for direct sales firms" → buyer scrolls past Google ads to see who's listed in The Manifest, Clutch, DSN), and feed the LLMs structured business data they use to answer "who does X" queries.

This is the cheapest workstream by time-per-asset (30-60 minutes per directory) and the easiest to delegate. Run it in parallel with podcast outreach and guest content. The goal is 30+ live listings within the first 90 days.

How directories actually move the needle

Three distinct benefits, in declining order of impact:

1. **Authority signal to Google.** Each accepted listing adds a referring domain. Domain rating is logarithmic — first 20 quality referring domains move it more than the next 200. Concentrate on Tier 1.
 2. **Buyer-side discovery.** Operators looking for compliance, culture, or AI consulting frequently search through directories rather than open web search. The Manifest, Clutch, DSN's vendor list, and industry-specific listings put Paradigm in the consideration set at the moment of intent.
 3. **LLM training data.** Structured business listings on high-trust sites become part of the data ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, and Google AI Overviews use to answer business-recommendation queries. The more consistent and complete the listings, the more reliably Paradigm surfaces.
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Master directory list (target: ~30 live listings in 90 days)

Tier 1 — High-authority B2B service directories (pitch first)

Directory	DR (approx.)	Cost	Notes
Clutch.co	91	Free listing; paid promoted profiles	Strongest single-directory backlink. Requires client review submissions to populate. Reach out to 3 past clients before submission.
The Manifest	62	Free	Clutch-owned; submission flows through Clutch profile.
GoodFirms	76	Free	Profile + 2 client reviews unlock full visibility.
UpCity	70	Free + paid tiers	Strong B2B services profile. Free tier works for backlink; paid for lead flow.
DesignRush	67	Free	Categorized by service type — list under "Business Consulting" and "Compliance Consulting."
Sortlist	76	Free	EU-centric but globally indexed. Good for international authority.
F6S	75	Free	Originally for startups; accepts established consultancies.
Crunchbase	92	Free + paid Pro	Free org profile. Add team, funding (if any), recent news. Significant LLM weight.

Tier 2 — Industry-specific directories

For each Paradigm pillar (compliance, culture, tech), list in the directories that the buyer audience already trusts. These produce fewer raw backlinks than Tier 1 but higher-intent visits.

Direct selling / network marketing:

- [Direct Selling News \(DSN\) Service Provider Directory](#) — paid annual listing; consider after the first podcast appearance on DSN's podcast warms the relationship.
- [DSA \(Direct Selling Association\) Vendor Directory](#) — Supplier Member directory; requires membership.
- [DSAEF](#) — Direct Selling Education Foundation; partner directory.
- [World of Direct Selling](#) — practitioner directory; pitch to Hakki Ozmorali directly.
- [Business For Home](#) — directory of MLM advisors and consultants.

Insurance:

- [Insurance Journal Directory](#) — agency partner listings; paid.
- [National Underwriter Insurance Pro Directory](#) — agency service providers.
- [Insurance Business America Service Provider Index](#) — paid.

Service businesses (HVAC, solar, plumbing, roofing):

- [ACCA \(Air Conditioning Contractors of America\) Allied Partner directory](#) — service partner listing for HVAC.
- [Solar Power World "Service Provider" directory](#) — solar-adjacent service vendors.
- [Service Roundtable](#) — service business partner directory.
- [HVAC.com Pro Network](#) — service provider listings.
- [Roofing Contractor Directory](#) — partner profiles.

Tech / AI for business:

- [Built In](#) — city-based tech directories (NY, SF, LA, Austin, etc.); useful even if Paradigm isn't a tech company per se because the AI-for-service angle fits.
- [AI Tool Report directories](#) / [TheresAnAIForThat](#) — listings for AI consulting / agentic workflow providers.
- [Stack Share](#) — tech-stack adjacent.

Tier 3 — Speaker / expert directories (for the founders, not Paradigm)

These build founder authority specifically. Each founder gets a profile with bio, headshot, speaking topics, and a link back to /team#[anchor].

Directory	DR (approx.)	Cost	Notes
SpeakerHub	65	Free	Strong for cold inbound speaking inquiries.
eSpeakers	60	Free + paid tiers	High-authority for speaker SEO.
Big Speak Speakers Bureau	65	Application-based	Higher bar but worth the application.
Speakers.com	58	Application-based	
BookingAgentInfo	70	Paid	Mostly for entertainment but accepts business speakers.
Lecturer.com	50	Free	Lower-tier but accepts most profiles.

Tier 4 — Founder / exec personal brand directories

Each founder gets a profile on each.

Directory	DR (approx.)	Cost	Notes
LinkedIn Company Page	99	Free	Paradigm Consulting page + each founder profile fully optimized. Critical baseline.
Apollo Company Profile	85	Free	Already indexed in B2B sales workflows. Verify org info is correct.
ZoomInfo Company Profile	85	Free	Used by sales / RevOps teams to find consultancies. Claim and update.
Glassdoor	90	Free	Only worth claiming if hiring or planning to hire.
Better Business Bureau	88	Paid (~\$500/yr)	Accreditation is paid; worth it for buyer trust in some categories.
Forbes Business Council / Tech Council / Coaches Council	95	Paid (~\$2,400/yr per founder)	Application-based; high DR and broad reach. Useful for one founder at a time, not all three.
YEC (Young Entrepreneur Council)	90	Paid	Application-based; under-40 founders.
Vistage member directory	75	Paid (membership-based)	If any founder is a Vistage member, ensure the profile is public.

Tier 5 — Low-effort backfill (DR-stacking, batch submit)

Submit these as a batch. Lower per-asset value but together they add up.

- [BizDirect](#), [Manta](#), [Hotfrog](#), [Yelp for Business](#), [Yellow Pages](#), [MerchantCircle](#), [Best of the Web](#), [Brownbook](#), [Cylex](#), [N49](#), [Foursquare for Business](#), [Yandex Business](#).
- Plus the local SEO baseline: [Google Business Profile](#), [Bing Places](#), [Apple Business Connect](#).

Each takes 10-15 minutes to populate. Batch in a single 2-3 hour session.

Submission template

Every directory asks for substantially the same information. Pre-write the canonical answers once; copy-paste per directory. Edits per-directory are minor.

Company name: Paradigm Consulting

URL: <https://paradigmconsulting.io>

Tagline (60 chars): Compliance, culture, and technology systems for scaling service busi

Description (150 chars):

We install the compliance, culture, and technology systems service businesses need to scale past \$5M, \$10M, and \$50M without rebuilding.

Description (500 chars):

Paradigm Consulting installs the operating systems service businesses need to scale: compliance frameworks that hold under regulatory scrutiny, culture infrastructure that holds when founders step back, and AI / agentic systems that turn existing tools into operating leverage. The team has structured compliance across \$2.5B+ in sales volume and 200,000+ distributors. Engagements typically run 90 days and produce documented infrastructure rather than reports.

Categories (pick best fit per directory):

- Business consulting
- Management consulting
- Compliance consulting
- Regulatory consulting
- Organizational development
- Sales consulting
- HR consulting
- AI consulting
- Technology consulting
- Service business consulting

Industries served:

- Direct selling / network marketing / MLM
- Insurance agencies
- HVAC / home services
- Solar
- Trade and field services
- IT services
- Professional services

Locations served: United States

Founded: [YEAR]

Headcount: [RANGE]

Year founded: [YEAR]

Languages: English

Hours: 9am-6pm ET, Monday-Friday

Phone: [PHONE]

Email: contact@paradigmconsulting.io

Logo: [brand_assets/paradigm-logo-white.webp](#) (1200x1200 transparent PNG version available at [brand_assets/optimized/paradigm-logo-square.png](#))

Header image: [brand_assets/og-image.jpg](#) (1200x630)

Founder bios + headshots: <https://paradigmconsulting.io/team>

Key services / offerings:

- Compliance Spine – 90-day compliance installation
- Compliance Spine Risk Map – \$4,995 productized 2-week assessment
- Culture Systems – 90-day culture installation
- Technology Systems – agentic and AI infrastructure
- 3x30S – the full operating system across all three pillars

Social profiles:

LinkedIn: [URL]
X / Twitter: [URL]
Instagram: [URL]
YouTube: [URL]

Submission workflow

1. **Batch credentials.** Use a dedicated email (directories@paradigmconsulting.io or a Gmail filter) for confirmation emails. Many directories require email verification; centralizing this prevents lost confirmations.
 2. **Pre-fill the boilerplate.** All canonical data lives in one shared doc. Per-directory edits are minor (category names vary, character limits vary).
 3. **Submit in batches of 5-10.** Block 90-120 minutes per batch. Run 1-2 batches per week.
 4. **Track every submission immediately.** A submission you don't track is a backlink you can't audit.
 5. **Verify within 14 days.** Some directories take 1-2 weeks to approve. After 14 days, check status; resubmit if rejected.
 6. **Audit live status quarterly.** Some directories silently delist after 6-12 months. Quarterly link-rot audits keep the asset live.
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Tracking spreadsheet schema

Column	Notes
Directory name	
Directory URL	
Tier (1-5)	
DR (Ahrefs)	At submission
Cost	Free / \$X / annual
Submission date	
Account email used	
Submission status	submitted / approved / rejected / live / delisted
Listing URL	After approval
Backlink confirmed	YES/NO — verify with Ahrefs or manual check
Referral traffic (90 days)	From GA4
Notes	Any issues, contact, or future action
Last audited	Quarterly

Cadence and quotas

- **Week 1-2:** Stand up the boilerplate doc and a shared submission email. Submit the 8 Tier 1 directories. ~6 operator-hours total.
- **Week 3-6:** Submit Tier 2 industry-specific listings. ~8-10 listings depending on which industries are active. ~10 operator-hours total.
- **Week 7-8:** Submit Tier 3 speaker / expert directories — one profile per founder, three founders. ~6 operator-hours total.
- **Week 9-12:** Submit Tier 4 founder / personal brand directories and Tier 5 backfill in batches. ~8 operator-hours total.

90-day target: 30+ live listings, 15+ from Tier 1 and 2 (the ones that actually move the needle).

Total operator time, 90 days: ~30 hours, batched into ~10 sessions of 2-3 hours each.

Hard rules

- **Consistency across listings.** Same name, same tagline, same description, same logo, same phone. LLMs cross-reference; inconsistency degrades the citation pattern.
 - **Do not pay for promoted slots in Tier 1 until organic listings are live.** Promoted directory placements rarely produce the inbound volume to justify the cost at Paradigm's stage.
 - **Refuse "directory submission services."** They're spam farms. Each submission is fast enough to do directly.
 - **Submit under a real human, not the operator's name.** Most directories show submitter as a contact; use one of the founders (Matt as the default since he's the public-facing founder).
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When this is working

- 30+ live listings after 90 days.
- 15+ referring domains attributable to directory submissions in Ahrefs / Search Console.
- Top 5 Tier 1 directories driving inbound traffic above 50 sessions/month combined by month 6.
- Branded search results showing Paradigm Consulting in directory snippets when buyers search "[service] consulting" + industry.
- LLM responses (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews) starting to cite Paradigm when asked "who builds compliance systems for direct selling companies" or "who does AI for service businesses."